

An Apple a day...

If you did get your hands on last month's FastTrack, you know that we covered all things Apple from the hardware perspective. Now, regardless of whether you're an Apple loyalist or an Android enthusiast, it is undeniable that there is more to an ecosystem than great (or horrible) hardware. In fact, software and services have often determined the market share and popularity of a particular ecosystem in ways that the hardware couldn't even dream of on its own. Apple fanboys will often tell you software is especially important when it comes to the poster-child of innovation in the tech world. And they're not wrong.

Though the irony is that Apple doesn't have the best reputation among non-Apple users who often use the bad software argument to deride the Cupertino-based software giant's ecosystem. We've often heard stuff like, "Your iPhone can't even do X task? Pff! What's the point of selling your kidneys for it?" or "Hey, your MacBook doesn't have Y feature? Look at what my Windows laptop can do for half the money".

While most members of Team Digit are proud comrades of the PC Master Race, it's essential to check whether all of these arguments and accusations hold their strength from an ecosystem point of view. Often these are half baked arguments that could very well be applied to specific devices and services from other ecosystems.

The Apple ecosystem is strung together by a tight knit design approach that is focussed on making sure that things "just work". Whether that actually happens or not seems to vary from iteration to iteration, device to device, year to year (Case in point - the latest Macbook dongle fiasco, iOS 8.0.1 etc). Regardless an individual deeply invested in this ecosystem